

creativity, Zuckerberg's network building acumen, or James's physical talents.

On the other side of this debate, people point to recent studies that show college graduates earn more to validate the importance of having that college degree. A study from Georgetown University found college graduates earn on average \$1 million more than others over their lifetime. Another study by the Pew Research Center found college graduates earned about \$17,500 more annually than high school graduates. These statistics make a strong argument for college.

Let's look at the pro-college arguments more closely. How many years would you have to work, earning an additional \$17,500 annually, to reach the \$1 million lifetime earnings advantage? Answer: more than fifty-seven years! If your goal is to lock yourself into a career, then work to earn as much money as possible over your lifetime, college probably does make sense. But what if you want to *Choose FI* and achieve it quickly?

Many people who purposefully pursue FI are able to do so in ten to twenty years. FI can be achieved in under a decade if you take a more aggressive approach. This requires adding variables to the equation to make an informed decision.